JAGGAER CONTENT BRIEF

Steel, Aluminum & Rare Earth Volatility: A Mid-2026 Reality Check for Procurement Teams

TOFU · Geography: ALL · Data Snapshot · Cluster anchor piece · Informational

Brief at a glance

URL SLUG	/steel-aluminum-rare-earth-price-volatility-procurement (technical slug only — mirrors the primary keyword; H1 and framing untouched)
CONTENT TYPE	Data Snapshot — Critical Minerals & Commodity Risk **cluster anchor** (per project brief). This cluster already has one spoke built ("Most Procurement Platforms Are Missing Critical Mineral Risk in the Auto Supply Chain") — this anchor should link down to it, and that spoke's own linking plan should be updated to link back up here once both are live.
TARGET WORD COUNT	1,800–2,200 words — anchor-depth, stat-led across three commodities (steel, aluminum, rare earths) rather than one. Word count is a byproduct of how many verified data points earn a place, not a prose target.
TARGET AUDIENCE	Procurement and category managers responsible for steel, aluminum, or magnet-dependent direct materials, trying to work out whether 2026's price swings are temporary noise or a structural new normal to plan budgets and contracts around. TOFU: they've felt the cost pressure but haven't seen it laid out commodity-by-commodity with current numbers.
FUNNEL / GEO / PATH	TOFU · Geography: ALL · Publishing Week 3 (per project card)
PRIMARY KEYWORD	steel aluminum price volatility procurement 2026 — stakeholder-specified, kept exactly as given. Does not appear in the keyword export pulled for this brief, which covers a different topic entirely (see Section 2's stakeholder note). Drives H1/title/framing only.
SECONDARY KEYWORD	commodity procurement risk data — stakeholder-specified, kept exactly as given. Loosely thematically related to the supplied export (which covers "commodity procurement" generically), but not the price-volatility angle this piece actually takes.
PILLAR PAGE LINK	No Discrete Manufacturing pillar page exists yet (same gap flagged in all three prior pieces in this pillar). As the cluster anchor, this piece links down to the existing spoke — see Section 5.
PUBLISH PRIORITY	High — this is the cluster anchor, and every underlying number is moving in real time (Section 232 tariff tiers changed as recently as June 2026; rare earth prices moved double digits month-over-month through Q2 2026). Publish while the data is current, and flag it for review sooner than a typical anchor piece.

1. Search intent analysis

The reader has felt the cost pressure — a quote that came back higher than expected, a supplier citing "tariff surcharges," a budget that no longer holds — and wants to know if this is a blip or the new baseline, commodity by commodity. This is TOFU, but data-hungry TOFU: they want current numbers, not a general "supply chains are volatile" narrative they've already read a dozen times this year.

What the reader needs to leave with

- Current, specific numbers for all three commodities: what steel and aluminum tariffs actually cost right now, and how far rare earth prices have moved in 2026.
- Why these three commodities are volatile for different reasons — tariff policy for steel and aluminum, export-control-driven scarcity for rare earths — and why that means they need different mitigation approaches, not one blanket strategy.
- Whether this is temporary or structural: the tariff regime has a stated end date (Section 232's current structure runs through 31 December 2027), while rare earth concentration is a longer-term structural issue.
- A next step: read the critical-minerals-in-automotive spoke for the deeper procurement-platform angle, or explore JAGGAER's tariff and geopolitical risk modeling.

SERP features to target

- **Featured snippet** — a single current-data sentence per commodity, directly under the H1.
- **People Also Ask** — FAQ section (Section 6) reframed around "is this temporary" and "what changed recently" rather than generic commodity-market explainers.

Competitive gap: AL Circle's aluminium casting piece is genuinely strong and current (published 24 July 2026, with hard LME/Midwest premium numbers) but is written for the aluminium casting trade specifically, not procurement broadly, and doesn't cover steel or rare earths at all. Coverage of Section 232's 2026 restructuring (April and June proclamations) is thorough on the trade/logistics/legal side (CRS, White & Case, tariff-tracking tools) but none of it is written for a procurement audience trying to plan sourcing decisions. Rare earth price tracking is abundant but scattered across investor- and mining-industry-focused sites, none connecting it back to steel/aluminum tariff volatility as a combined "commodity risk" story for procurement. No source reviewed brings all three commodities together for a procurement reader — that's this piece's job.

> **STAKEHOLDER NOTE — KEYWORD EXPORT MISMATCH**
> Primary/secondary keywords are stakeholder-set, kept exactly as given. However, the supplied keyword export (72 keywords, generic "commodity procurement" theme) does not match this piece's actual topic. See Section 2 for the full explanation and a recommended follow-up keyword pull.

2. Target keywords

Primary & secondary (topical anchors — kept exactly as specified)

KEYWORD	MSV	KD	INTENT
steel aluminum price volatility procurement 2026	~0	n/a	Stakeholder-set primary — drives H1/title/framing, unchanged
commodity procurement risk data	~0	n/a	Stakeholder-set secondary — kept as-is, unchanged

THIS EXPORT DOESN'T MATCH THIS PIECE'S TOPIC

The supplied keyword list (72 keywords after removing duplicates, mostly 0–20 MSV) is built entirely around generic "commodity procurement" as a *discipline* — SAP module names, USDA program terminology, job titles and salaries, government commodity codes, procurement-vs-buying definitions, even a Treasury sanctions notice. None of it relates to steel, aluminum, or rare earth *price volatility*, which is what this piece is actually about. This looks like a keyword pull for a different, more generic "what is commodity procurement" piece that ended up attached to this brief by mistake. Recommend re-pulling keywords specifically on terms like "aluminum price 2026," "steel tariff price," "Section 232 steel aluminum," "rare earth price surge," and "LME aluminum price" before finalizing this section.

What's usable from the supplied export (thin, but not zero)

KEYWORD	MSV	KD	INTENT
what is commodity procurement	20	n/a	Informational — generic definitional bridge, usable in an intro line only
what is commodity management in procurement	20	n/a	Informational — same use case
commodity strategy procurement	10	n/a	Informational — loosely supports a "how to respond strategically" section

Everything else in the export — SAP/USDA/government-program specifics, job titles and salaries, contract templates, county-level commodity codes, a Treasury sanctions notice, and dozens of zero-volume near-duplicates — is not usable for this piece and is not listed here. This is a data quality flag, not a trimming judgment call like in prior briefs; the export simply covers a different subject.

3. Recommended page structure

H1 (Title)	Steel, Aluminum & Rare Earth Volatility: A Mid-2026 Reality Check for Procurement Teams (kept exactly as specified)
Meta title	Steel, Aluminum, Rare Earth Prices: 2026 Data — 45 characters
Meta description	See the actual 2026 price data on steel, aluminum, and rare earth volatility, and what it means for procurement. — 112 characters
Intro (100–150 words)	Snippet-ready: state plainly that this is a three-commodity data snapshot, not a forecast, and give one headline number per commodity immediately (e.g. 50% steel/aluminum tariffs, +138% YTD rare earth prices). Work "what is commodity procurement" in as a one-line framing bridge, not a definitional detour.
H2: Steel — What's Actually Changed in 2026	Section 232 timeline: 25%→50% (June 2025), April 6 2026 restructuring (50% wholly-metal / 25% derivative, full customs value), June 8 2026 proclamation (temporary structure through 31 Dec 2027). Steel mill products +20.7% YoY (AGC of America, Jan 2025–Jan 2026). Primary visual (stat grid) goes here (Section 4).
H2: Aluminum — The Two-Tier Market	LME benchmark $3,400–3,800/t; US Midwest premium hit a record ~$2,182/t in early 2026 (crossed $1/lb for the first time); US all-in price >$5,340/t, ~70% above international. Aluminum mill shapes +33% YoY (AGC of America). Note the CBAM connection: recycled aluminium content is now a financial lever, not just a green one — cross-link to the CBAM piece.
H2: Rare Earths — A Different Kind of Volatile	NdPr alloy: ~$53/kg (1 Jan 2026) → ~$126/kg (1 April 2026), +138% YTD; dysprosium +15.6% to ~$221/kg (April 2026); no commercial-scale Western terbium production exists at all. Explain why this is structurally different from steel/aluminum tariff volatility: it's concentration and export-licensing driven, not a tariff rate someone could roll back. Secondary visual goes here (Section 4).
H2: Temporary Noise or Structural Shift?	Steel/aluminum tariffs have a stated (if extendable) end point; rare earth concentration doesn't. Different commodities need different procurement responses — this is the differentiation section. Flag for product marketing sign-off before naming any specific JAGGAER capability.
H2: FAQ	8 questions — see Section 6.
H2: Next steps	Link to the critical-minerals-in-automotive spoke, the CBAM piece, and the Discrete Manufacturing pillar page once it exists (Section 5). No new information here.

4. Visual production notes

Primary visual

A three-column stat grid, one column per commodity, each with its single headline 2026 number. Appears within the first two scrolls, near the top.

50% Section 232 tariff on wholly steel/aluminum imports (2026)	**$2,182/t** record US aluminum Midwest premium, early 2026	**+138%** NdPr rare earth alloy price, YTD through April 2026

Secondary visual

A simple two-row comparison: "Tariff-driven volatility" (steel, aluminum — policy lever, stated end date, could reverse) vs. "Concentration-driven volatility" (rare earths — structural, no near-term Western alternative, no policy off-switch). Appears under H2: Temporary Noise or Structural Shift?

SIGN-OFF & VERIFICATION NEEDED

Do not name a specific JAGGAER module or capability claim without product marketing confirmation, same rule as the other three pieces in this pillar. Rare earth pricing sources disagree on exact benchmark levels depending on whether they track domestic China, FOB China, oxide, or alloy prices — this brief used the most granular, consistently-sourced series found (SMM-based data via rare-earth-mining.com and Benchmark Minerals) rather than a single dramatic headline figure ("sixfold") found in one secondary geopolitical analysis piece. Verify whichever specific figures make the final draft against a live pricing service before publishing, since these numbers move monthly.

5. Internal linking plan

Pillar page — Discrete Manufacturing	Does not exist yet — TBC, same gap as the other three pieces.
Spoke — "Most Procurement Platforms Are Missing Critical Mineral Risk..."	"the procurement-platform angle on this" · Rare Earths section — update that piece's own linking plan to link back up to this anchor once both are live.
Cluster — "CBAM & the Carbon Cost of Your Supply Chain"	"how CBAM adds to the aluminum cost picture" · Aluminum section
Product — JAGGAER Manufacturing (jaggaer.com/vertical/manufacturing)	"JAGGAER's tariff and geopolitical risk modeling" · Temporary Noise or Structural Shift section — verified real page, publicly lists this capability.

As the cluster anchor, this piece should end up with the most inbound links of anything in the Critical Minerals & Commodity Risk cluster — revisit this table each time a new spoke publishes.

6. FAQ targets

- Why did steel and aluminum tariffs increase again in 2026?
- What is the US Midwest aluminum premium, and why does it matter?
- Are steel and aluminum tariffs temporary or permanent?
- Why are rare earth prices rising so much faster than steel or aluminum?
- Is rare earth price volatility likely to ease in 2026?
- How does CBAM affect aluminum sourcing decisions?
- Should procurement handle tariff risk and rare earth risk the same way?
- What should procurement teams do differently given these three commodities right now?

7. SEO and technical requirements

URL	/steel-aluminum-rare-earth-price-volatility-procurement (no date — evergreen)
Title tag	Steel, Aluminum, Rare Earth Prices: 2026 Data — 45 characters
Meta description	See the actual 2026 price data on steel, aluminum, and rare earth volatility, and what it means for procurement. — 112 characters
Schema markup	Article + FAQPage schema on the FAQ section. Consider Dataset markup for the stat grid, since the page's core value is the price data itself.
Update cadence	**High — review monthly, or immediately on any Section 232 proclamation or major rare earth export-control announcement.** Every number in this piece is a snapshot in time; the "mid-2026" framing in the H1 itself has a shelf life.
Canonical	Self-canonical. No date variants — but the "Mid-2026" framing in the title means this piece likely needs a full refresh (not just a data update) by early 2027.
Disclaimer	Recommended: note that all prices and tariff rates reflect a specific point in time and are sourced from third-party market reporting and government proclamations; readers should verify current rates before making sourcing or budgeting decisions.

8. Recommended sources

- Congressional Research Service (via congress.gov) — Section 232 tariff summaries on steel, aluminum, and copper (fetched and reviewed for this brief) — the primary source for the tariff timeline and rate structure.
- AL Circle — "Aluminium casting prices in 2026" (fetched and verified for this brief, published 24 July 2026) — LME, Midwest premium, and all-in price figures.
- Associated General Contractors of America — steel mill products and aluminum mill shapes year-over-year price data (cited via multiple industry sources; verify directly against AGC's own published data before publishing).
- Benchmark Minerals and SMM (Shanghai Metals Market)-sourced rare earth pricing (via rare-earth-mining.com's market analyses, fetched for this brief) — NdPr, dysprosium, and terbium price series.
- European Commission — CBAM certificate pricing (already verified for the CBAM piece in this same pillar).

Source note: of the six links supplied for this brief, AL Circle's aluminium casting piece was fetched and verified directly; the other five (smartglassquality.com, alumeco.com, metal-sentinel.com, insights.linesight.com, metals-hub.com) were not independently reviewed in this pass — recommend the writer check them directly for any additional data points before drafting. This brief's keyword export did not match its topic (see Section 2). This document is not legal, tax, or financial advice.